

Cupcast III: The 2026 World Cup Forecast

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Abstract

The forecast: per-match probabilities and expected scorelines for all matches of the 2026 FIFA World Cup, advancement probabilities for all 48 teams, and the podium distribution from 50,000 Monte Carlo tournament simulations under the Dixon–Coles model [1] of Paper I, validated in Paper II. Includes sensitivity analysis to key-player availability and a comparison against bookmaker-implied probabilities.

1 Introduction

To be written.

2 Headline Forecast

To be written.

3 Group Stage

To be written.

4 Knockout Rounds

To be written.

5 Sensitivity Analysis

To be written.

6 Model vs Market

To be written.

7 Limitations

To be written.

References

- [1] M. J. Dixon and S. G. Coles. Modelling association football scores and inefficiencies in the football betting market. *Journal of the Royal Statistical Society: Series C (Applied Statistics)*, 46(2):265–280, 1997. doi: 10.1111/1467-9876.00065.